

The Estimate Bottleneck — Your Play

How to actually run the conversation. Keep this in your pocket, not in any shared folder.

THE ONE LINE THAT KEEPS YOU SAFE

You are never the guy going after a 35-year veteran. You are the tech who spotted an efficiency gain and wants to protect the shop's best asset. Attack the **system that wastes his judgment**, never his judgment. If the conversation ever drifts toward "he does it wrong," pull it back to "his time is too valuable to spend on oil changes."

IF YOU PITCH THE DVI TO THE MANAGER DIRECTLY — SAY THIS

*"[Manager], right now you're walking out to the bays to eyeball every recommendation the three of us make — it's eating your whole day and you're the one getting worn out. With the video inspection, we shoot a 15-second clip of the actual failure — the loose tie rod, the leaking strut — and push it to your tablet. For the clear-cut stuff you price it right from your desk; for the real judgment calls you still walk out like always. That same video goes to the customer's phone, so they **see exactly what we see** — fewer fights, more approvals. You're still making every call. You're just not wearing out your knees to do it."*

IF HE SAYS: "I NEED TO SEE IT MYSELF"

Agree instantly. He still walks out for the judgment calls — the video only saves the trips that never needed him. Then stop. Don't argue past it; let it sit and let him come to it.

IF HE GOES QUIET / NON-COMMITTAL

That's fine — you're planting, not closing. "No rush, just figured it'd save you the steps." Let the idea be his by next week.

PLAY IT IN THIS ORDER

1. **Run the 30-day tracker first, quietly.** Log it straight and honest. The numbers do the arguing so you don't have to.
2. **Take the business case to Jack** — the owner brief, with your real numbers. Throughput + liability. Let the owner carry it to the lifer.
3. **The DVI is the wedge, not the whole fix.** Win the camera first. Once tech-shot video is normal, your diagnostic voice is back in every rec and the data trail makes thresholds easy later. Don't try to solve the under/over-selling or the gate in round one.
4. **Stay curious about the "why."** Ask what made him start checking every car himself — there may be a real reason (a burned customer, an old lawsuit) you can address head-on. Curiosity opens the door that any argument slams.

For Reed only. The owner-facing version of this is the Estimate Bottleneck brief in the Jack packet — case, not choreography.